

ISM 555 – Project Management

Deliverable #1 - Project Charter

Project Title	Surplus to Serve
Project Scope Overview	"Surplus to Serve" is a project that aims to reduce food waste on the NAU campus and help those in need by redistributing surplus food from campus dining units (such as Hotspot, Dub's, Coops, Pizza Hut, Cobrizo) to individuals facing food insecurity. The goal is to support the community, promote sustainability, and reduce waste.
Product Description / Deliverables	Redistribution Model: A system for collecting and redistributing surplus food. Safe Food Handling: Guidelines to ensure food safety during collection and distribution. Sustainability: Composting any food that can't be redistributed, to maintain eco-friendly practices. Volunteer Framework: Recruiting and training students and community members to help with daily operations. Impact Tracking: A way to measure the amount of food saved and its positive effects on the community.
Project Objectives	1. Provide surplus food to those in need on campus. 2. Reduce food waste and promote sustainability. 3. Engage volunteers and local organizations. 4. Showcase NAU's commitment to the community and the environment.
Background/ Business Case	At NAU, dining units often have leftover food at the end of the day, which is usually composted. While composting is good for the environment, giving that food to people who need it could have an even bigger impact. With many people in the community facing hunger, "Surplus to Serve" is an effort to reduce food waste while supporting those in need.
Resource Estimates	Initial Costs (One-Time Setup): • Stall Structure: \$5,000 • Storage Equipment: \$1,000 • Packaging Materials: \$200 • Signage & Banners: \$100 • Safety Gear: \$100 • Transport Cart: \$500 • Technology/Tracking Tools: \$150 • Insulated food bags: \$100 • Total Initial Setup Cost: \$7,000-\$8000 Monthly Operating Costs: • Packaging Materials (Refills): \$100-\$150 • Volunteer Incentives (Certificates, Rewards): \$150-\$200 • Transportation Cost (In Emergency): \$1000-\$1500

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Name	Title	Role/Responsibility
Chris Paige	Sponsor	Sponsor
Summary Milestone Schedule		
Description		Due Date
Phase 1 (Ex. Project Preparation...)		
Project Planning: Identify key partners like dining units and volunteers. Estimate costs and list needed resources. Partner Engagement & Requirement Collection		February 5, 2025
Phase 2 (Ex. Collect Requirements..)		
Partner Engagement & Requirement Collection: Work with dining units to collect surplus food. Learn about food safety rules and logistics. Connect with student groups and community partners.		February 15, 2025
Phase 3 (Ex. Design Phase...)		
Design Redistribution Model & Safety Guidelines: Create a simple system for collecting, storing, and distributing food. Set clear food safety rules to follow.		March 1, 2025
Phase 4 (Ex. Development Phase...)		
Infrastructure Setup & Volunteer Recruitment: Get storage, transport, and safety equipment ready.		March 20, 2025
Phase 5 (Ex. Prototype Testing...)		

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Pilot Program Testing & Evaluation: Test the program on a small scale with select dining units. Check if the system runs smoothly and food stays safe. Use the backup volunteer system to manage absences. Decide on the transportation team and assign roles. Gather feedback and make improvements.		April 5, 2025
Phase 6 (Ex. User Acceptance and Training...)		
Full Implementation & Awareness Campaign: Launch the program in all dining units. Promote it through social media and campus events.		April 20, 2025
Phase 7 (Ex. Go Live and Lessons Learned...)		
Monitoring, Reporting & Project Closure: Check how well the volunteer system worked and improve if needed. Share results and plan for long-term success.		May 9, 2025
Assumptions 1.Dining units will be willing to participate and donate surplus food. 2.Volunteers will be available to help with daily operations. 3.The program will gain support from the community. 4.Use Campus Transport Services: Partner with university shuttles or logistics for food transport. 5.Student Volunteer Transport Team: Recruit students with cars by offer incentives, Fuel Charges & participation certificates .		Constraints 1.Adherence to local food safety laws. 2.Limited budget for initial setup. 3.Storage and distribution challenges for perishable items. 4.Collecting surplus food from multiple dining units can be challenging and require extra planning.
High-Level Project Risks	Dining Unit's Participation: Dining units might not participate as expected. Solution: Build strong relationships and emphasize the program's benefits. Volunteer Availability: There may be a shortage of volunteers. Solution: Partner with student organizations to ensure consistent volunteer support. Food Safety & Quality: There could be concerns about the safety or quality of the food. Solution: Implement strict food handling protocols and regular inspections.	

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Signatures	Project Sponsor Prof. Chris Paige	Project Manager/Team Vamshi Aitharaju Bhavani Koukuntla Navya Sri Katta Jahnvi Chalapaka
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